

RAHMANIA

Cue the fanfare. Let the drums roll. A.R. Rahman won two Oscars for the song and score of *Slumdog Millionaire*. He also won every Hollywood A-lister's heart.



RAHMAN AFTER
WINNING THE
TWO OSCARS

AP PHOTO/MATT SAYLES

| By Kaveree Bamzai |

can use it as a dumbbell," says A.R. Rahman after six hours of posing patiently with his Golden Globe for an array of photographers in a trophy-bedecked visitors' room in his Chennai home. Some trophies are squashed on the parapet, others line his manager's wall, others he admits sheepishly are lost, while yet others may well find a home on ebay.

That was a month ago. It's unlikely that his 176th and 177th trophies, the two Oscars for Best Original Score and Best Song, will meet the same fate. Let the British feel good about sweeping the Oscars with a movie made by their tiny industry and let the Americans feel better in an Obama year about hope for their nation, India has its own world-class achiever. Like a

“THE ESSENCE OF THIS FILM IS OPTIMISM. ALL MY LIFE I HAD A CHOICE OF LOVE OR HATE. I CHOSE LOVE, AND I'M HERE.”

A.R. RAHMAN